Mosquito Hunters

Franchise Decision Report

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Executive Summary

Mosquito Hunters is a PE-backed combination franchise (Pest Hunters / Mosquito Hunters / Humbug Holiday Lighting) with the highest cost to enter in the mosquito pest control cohort: $141,295–$170,743, anchored by a $107,000 initial franchise fee that is more than double the next most expensive brand. At $300K gross revenue, annual franchisor fees total $80,300 (26.8% of revenue), driven by a mandatory marketing floor of $37,500 that functions as a regressive tax on smaller operators. The system is the smallest in the cohort at 135 franchised outlets, and its Item 19 — while containing 7 tables — does not disclose total revenue per franchise unit, making it impossible to build a revenue model from the FDD alone.

The strongest signal in this FDD is the 2024 turnaround: after 17 terminations in 2022 and 11 in 2023, the system recorded zero terminations and added 13 net outlets in 2024. The combination franchise model offers genuine diversification — the Humbug Holiday Lighting program generated $64,727 average revenue across 26 participating franchisees, providing meaningful winter-season income in a traditionally seasonal business. But a prospective buyer faces a core problem: you cannot assess unit economics from this document. The 26% exclusion rate in Item 19 (including 8 operators excluded for not investing in the franchisor's marketing programs) further limits the reliability of what is disclosed.

Fee Burden Analysis

Mosquito Hunters has the second-highest ongoing fee burden in the cohort at every modeled revenue level. The primary driver is the marketing floor: the $37,500 annual minimum is 18.75% of revenue at $200K, falling to 10% only at $375K+. Combined with a $9,000/year call center fee and $1,800/year technology fee, the fixed-cost layer is substantial.

AT REVENUE	ROYALTY	MARKETING	TECH / OTHER	TOTAL	% OF REV	COHORT RANK
$200,000	$20,000	$37,500	$12,800	**$70,300**	35.1%	4/5
$300,000	$30,000	$37,500	$12,800	**$80,300**	26.8%	3/5
$400,000	$40,000	$40,000	$12,800	**$92,800**	23.2%	3/5
$500,000	$50,000	$50,000	$12,800	**$112,800**	22.6%	3/5

Component breakdown

- **Royalty (10% flat):** Mid-cohort rate. Paid weekly on Net Revenues. An additional 15% royalty applies to any revenue earned outside your territory, bringing the out-of-territory rate to 25%. (p. 15)
- **Marketing ($37,500 or 10%, whichever is greater):** Three mandatory components: Local Advertising ($8,000 or 2%), Centrally Managed Media Fund ($26,500 or 7%), and Tools & Programs Fund ($3,000 or 1%). The $37,500 floor does not scale with revenue until you exceed $375,000 — below that, you pay more than 10%. Flagged as "Special Risk" in the FDD itself. (pp. 15–16, 19–20)
- **Technology ($150/mo):** Increases to $250/mo when cumulative Net Revenues reach $1,000,000. May increase up to $500/mo at franchisor's discretion. (p. 15)
- **Call Center ($750/mo):** First year included in franchise fee. May increase, not to exceed $1,000/mo. Adds $9,000/year in fixed cost from Year 2 forward. (p. 17)
- **Convention (up to $2,000/yr):** Must pay even if not attending. Travel and lodging are additional. (p. 17)

> **What this means:** At $300K revenue, you keep ~$220K after franchisor fees. At Mosquito Authority, you would keep ~$247K — a $27,500/year difference that compounds to $275,000 over a 10-year term. The marketing floor is the dominant factor: at $200K revenue, marketing alone consumes 18.75% of gross — nearly double the royalty rate.

> **SPECIAL RISK — MARKETING FLOOR**
>
> The FDD itself flags the marketing obligation as a "Special Risk" on page 4. The $37,500 annual minimum is the highest dollar-denominated marketing floor in the cohort after Mosquito Shield's $50,000. Unlike percentage-based marketing fees that scale with revenue, this floor creates a disproportionate burden on operators who are still building their customer base.

Item 19 Interpretation

Mosquito Hunters' Item 19 contains 7 tables across 10 pages — more granular than most competitors. But it has a critical gap: **no table discloses total revenue per franchise unit**. The tables provide building blocks (customer counts, per-treatment pricing, customer values) but never assemble them into a revenue figure. This omission is the single most important limitation of this FDD.

What is disclosed

- **Customer counts (Table A.1):** 63 qualifying SPs averaged 101–444 customers per quartile. Top quartile averaged 444 customers; bottom quartile averaged 101. (p. 55)
- **Per-treatment pricing (Table A.2):** Mosquito-only treatments average $72–$88 depending on region. (p. 56)
- **Customer value (Table A.4):** Average annual value per mosquito customer ranges from $726 (Region 2) to $1,232 (Region 4, which includes FL/LA/TX with longer seasons). (p. 58)
- **Holiday lighting (Table A.7):** 26 participating SPs averaged $64,727 in Humbug revenue, with a median of $53,701. Range: $2,899–$305,528. This is the most useful table in the Item 19 — actual revenue per franchisee for a defined service line. (p. 61)

What is missing

Total revenue per franchise unit. You can attempt to multiply customer counts by customer values, but the tables use different populations, different regional groupings, and different inclusion criteria. The FDD does not perform this calculation, and the data does not cleanly support doing it yourself.

The exclusion problem

22 of 85 Strategic Partners (26%) are excluded from Item 19 tables. Of those, 8 were excluded specifically for "failing to invest in MH marketing programs." This creates a circularity: the franchisor requires $37,500/year in marketing spend, excludes operators who do not meet that threshold from performance data, and then presents the remaining operators' results as representative. The disclosed performance data may overstate what a typical operator achieves.

> **What this means:** You cannot build a revenue model from this FDD. You know what customers pay per treatment ($72–$88) and how many customers top performers have (444 avg in Q1), but you do not know total revenue per unit. The holiday lighting data ($64,727 avg) is the one concrete revenue figure — and it applies to only 26 of 135 franchised outlets. To estimate unit economics, you will need to talk to current franchisees directly.

Investment Breakdown

Highest in the cohort: $141,295–$170,743. The $107,000 franchise fee ($50,000 license + $57,000 training/supply/support) accounts for 63–75% of the total investment. This is more than double Mosquito Authority's maximum franchise fee ($45,000) and the highest single line item across all five brands. The combination franchise model adds $8,400–$16,800 for holiday lighting inventory and equipment.

CATEGORY	LOW	HIGH
Initial License Fee	$50,000	$50,000
Training, Supply & Support Fee	$57,000	$57,000
Service Vehicle Deposit	$8,350	$16,700
Service Vehicle Lease Payment	$1,200	$1,525
Computer Software	$415	$656
Computers	$0	$2,000
Opening Mosquito Inventory	$500	$1,000
Holiday Lighting Start-Up Inventory	$6,000	$14,000
Holiday Lighting Start-Up Equipment	$2,400	$2,800
Uniforms	$250	$500
Rental Space	$0	$3,000
Bookkeeper	$400	$600
Training Expenses	$1,900	$4,400
Utility/Security Deposit	$200	$200
Insurance	$800	$1,000
Additional Funds — 3 Months	$11,880	$15,362
Total	**$141,295**	**$170,743**

What to know about the major line items

- **Franchise fee ($107,000):** Two components paid at signing: $50,000 license fee + $57,000 training/supply/support fee. Both nonrefundable. VetFran/MinorityFran/First Responder discount: 10% off the license portion ($5,000 savings). Additional territory: $25,000. (pp. 14–15)
- **Holiday lighting ($8,400–$16,800):** Inventory and equipment for Humbug Holiday Lighting — a mandatory component of the combination franchise. This is unique to Hunters and does not appear in any competitor's Item 7. (p. 21)

- **Service vehicle ($8,350–$16,700 deposit + $1,200–$1,525/mo lease):** 60- or 72-month lease with 10–20% down. Unlike Authority, there is no option to use an existing personal vehicle. (p. 21)
- **Working capital ($11,880–$15,362):** Only 3 months. For a seasonal business with near-zero winter mosquito revenue, this is tight. The holiday lighting program partially addresses seasonality, but first-year operators should plan for personal reserves well beyond this estimate. (p. 21)

> **What this means:** The minimum investment is $141,295, with no meaningful way to reduce it — the $107,000 fee is fixed and the vehicle is a lease, not optional. Compare this to Mosquito Authority, where a buyer with a qualifying truck can enter for ~$54,000. The $87,000+ gap in entry cost means Hunters franchisees need substantially more revenue just to reach breakeven on their investment.

System Health

Mosquito Hunters had a volatile three-year window that ended with a dramatic turnaround. The system shrank by 4 outlets in 2022 and 1 in 2023, with 28 total terminations across those two years. Then in 2024: zero terminations, 13 new openings, and net growth of +13 outlets. The swing from -4 to +13 is the sharpest year-over-year reversal in the cohort.

YEAR	START	OPENED	TERMINATED	TRANSFERRED	NET	END COUNT
2022	127	13	17	10	−4	123
2023	123	10	11	8	−1	122
2024	122	13	0	5	+13	135

The classification question

Every franchise closure across all three years is coded exclusively as a "Termination." Zero non-renewals. Zero ceased operations. Zero reacquisitions. Across 28 closures over two years, every single one was a franchisor-initiated termination. This is statistically unusual. Most franchise systems show a mix of terminations, non-renewals, and voluntary closures. When 100% of exits are coded as terminations, it suggests either an unusually aggressive franchisor posture or a classification methodology that categorizes all departures under a single bucket. Either interpretation deserves scrutiny. (pp. 62–67)

The 2024 reversal

Zero terminations in 2024 — after 17 in 2022 and 11 in 2023 — is a genuine positive signal. The franchisor projects 21 new franchised outlets in the next year (p. 68). Whether the improvement reflects better franchisee support, a change in enforcement posture, or simply the departure of underperformers in prior years is unclear from the FDD alone.

Transfer activity

10, 8, 5 transfers per year, declining. In a system of 122–135 outlets, this is a moderate rate (4–8%). Transfer activity declining alongside terminations may indicate improving franchisee satisfaction or simply a smaller pool of motivated sellers.

> **What this means:** The 3-year net growth of +8 outlets (127 to 135) is the second-weakest in the cohort after Mosquito Squad (+3). But the trajectory matters: the system was shrinking and is now growing. Ask the franchisor what changed in 2024 — whether it was a policy shift, better operator support, or the natural conclusion of pruning weak franchisees.

Risk Signals

No litigation

No litigation required to be disclosed in Item 3. Clean. This is notable in a system that terminated 28 franchisees over 2022–2023 — no terminated franchisee pursued claims that reached the disclosure threshold. (p. 14)

Classification methodology

All 28 closures across 2022–2023 are coded as "Terminations" — zero non-renewals or ceased operations across the entire 3-year reporting window. This uniform classification is unique among the five brands reviewed and may reflect how the franchisor categorizes exits rather than the actual circumstances of each departure. (pp. 62–67)

Item 19 exclusion rate

26% of Strategic Partners (22 of 85) are excluded from Item 19 performance data. Eight were excluded specifically for not investing in the franchisor's marketing programs — the same programs that cost $37,500/year minimum. Excluding underperformers who did not buy enough marketing from the performance tables creates a survivorship bias that overstates typical results. (p. 55)

Out-of-territory royalty

Revenue earned outside your territory incurs an additional 15% royalty on top of the standard 10%, for a combined 25% royalty rate. This is disclosed but easy to miss. If your territory is small or you serve customers near the boundary, this surcharge is material. (p. 15)

Entity and ownership

PE-backed (LD Parent, Inc. / CNL Strategic Capital, LLC). The brand has changed hands: the original concept was founded in 2013, current entity began May 2018. Now operating as a combination franchise covering pest control, mosquito control, and holiday lighting under three brand names. All five brands in this cohort are PE-backed; this is industry-standard.

Peer Context

Mosquito Hunters occupies an unusual position in the cohort: highest cost to enter, weakest disclosure on unit economics, smallest system — but with a combination franchise model that no competitor offers and a dramatic 2024 turnaround. The holiday lighting program provides a genuine answer to the seasonality problem that plagues every mosquito-focused franchise.

Closest comparison: Mosquito Joe. Both have high marketing spend floors (Hunters $37,500; Joe comparable), both charge 10% royalty, and both have total fee burdens in the 26–28% range at $300K revenue. Joe has a larger system (415 vs 135) and richer Item 19 data. Hunters has the combination franchise advantage and lower 2024 attrition.

Sharpest contrast: Mosquito Authority. Opposite on nearly every dimension. Authority: $54K–$127K investment, 17.6% fee burden, 546 outlets, zero terminations, rich Item 19 with per-franchisee revenue data. Hunters: $141K–$170K investment, 26.8% fee burden, 135 outlets, no total revenue disclosed. Authority is the low-cost/low-risk option; Hunters is a higher-cost bet on diversification through the combination franchise model.

METRIC	MOSQUITO AUTHORITY	MOSQUITO HUNTERS	MOSQUITO JOE	MOSQUITO SHIELD	MOSQUITO SQUAD
System size	546	135	415	435	226
Investment range	$54K–$127K	$141K–$170K	$150K–$192K	$120K–$157K	$162K–$220K
Fee burden at $300K	$52,800	$80,300	$84,752	$86,000	$77,880
% of revenue	17.6%	26.8%	28.3%	28.7%	26.0%
3-year net growth	+22	+8	+43	+140	+3
2024 attrition	1.8%	0.0%	5.7%	11.1%	4.3%
Royalty rate	10%	10%	10/7%	8%	10/9/8%

Questions for Discovery Day

These questions are derived from specific findings in the Mosquito Hunters 2025 FDD. They are designed to surface information the FDD does not fully explain.

1. The system went from 17 terminations in 2022 to zero in 2024. What specifically changed — franchisee support, enforcement policy, or something else?

Item 20, Tables 1–3, pp. 62–67. 28 terminations in 2022–2023, then zero.

2. Every franchise closure across all three reporting years is coded as a "Termination" — no non-renewals, no ceased operations. Why does every exit fall into a single category?

Item 20, Tables 1–3, pp. 62–67. Uniform classification across 28 closures is statistically unusual.

3. Item 19 excludes 22 of 85 Strategic Partners (26%), including 8 for not investing in MH marketing programs. What was the performance of those 8 excluded operators?

Item 19, Table A.1, p. 55. Exclusion for not buying marketing creates survivorship bias.

4. The Item 19 provides customer counts, per-treatment pricing, and customer values — but never total revenue per franchise unit. What is the average total revenue for a single-territory operator?

Item 19, Tables A.1–A.5, pp. 55–59. Critical gap: no total revenue figure disclosed.

5. The Humbug Holiday Lighting program shows $64,727 average revenue across 26 participants. What are the typical costs (labor, inventory replenishment, insurance) to generate that revenue?

Item 19, Table A.7, p. 61. Revenue disclosed but no cost data for holiday lighting.

6. The marketing floor is $37,500/year — flagged as a "Special Risk" in the FDD itself. Has there been any consideration of restructuring this as a pure percentage to reduce the burden on smaller operators?

Item 6, pp. 15–16, 19–20; Special Risk flag on p. 4.

7. Out-of-territory revenue incurs a 25% combined royalty (10% standard + 15% surcharge). How is "outside territory" determined for customers near a boundary, and how common is this surcharge in practice?

Item 6, p. 15. 15% additional royalty on out-of-territory Net Revenues.

8. The $107,000 franchise fee is the highest in the cohort by a wide margin. The training/supply/support component ($57,000) is larger than many competitors' entire franchise fee. What does this $57,000 specifically cover beyond initial training?

Item 5, pp. 14–15. $50K license + $57K training/supply = $107K total.

9. The technology fee starts at $150/month and may increase to $500/month at the franchisor's discretion. What would trigger an increase, and is there a cap beyond $500?

Item 6, p. 15. Current: $150/mo, jumps to $250/mo at $1M cumulative revenue, may go to $500/mo.

10. Working capital in Item 7 covers only 3 months ($11,880–$15,362). For a seasonal mosquito business, what do you recommend franchisees have in personal reserves to cover the first off-season?

Item 7, p. 21. 3-month working capital estimate in a seasonal business model.

Source & Methodology

Source document: Mosquito Hunters 2025 Franchise Disclosure Document, filed with the Wisconsin Department of Financial Institutions. 255-page regulator-source PDF. SHA-256: `2226332c1fc1ea66d75e56dfc717f6536ba3193867c48696e6955695dd36f931`

Extraction: Structured data extraction using pdfplumber with manual review. Field-level provenance recorded (source year, state, page number, item reference). Extraction confidence: high (3+ fields spot-checked against source).

Fee modeling: Year 5 assumptions, single territory, 1 owner + 1 technician. Revenue distributed evenly across the year. All mandatory fees enforced. Call center fee at $750/month (Year 2+). Technology fee at

$150/month. See fee_modeling_framework.md for full methodology.

Peer comparison: Same methodology applied to all 5 brands in cohort (Mosquito Authority, Mosquito Hunters, Mosquito Joe, Mosquito Shield, Mosquito Squad). All from 2025 FDDs filed with Wisconsin DFI.

Disclaimer: This report is not legal advice, investment advice, or a recommendation to buy or avoid this franchise. It is a structured analysis of publicly available regulatory filings. The buyer should read the actual FDD, consult a franchise attorney, and conduct their own due diligence before making any investment decision.